Trial by CRICKET

*Cricketer **Faf du Plessis** recalls key moments in his career as his no-holds-barred autobiography* **Faf Through Fire** *hits bookstores in India*



Q. People usually write autobiographies at the end of their careers. Why did you write yours now?

While I was playing for South Africa, I never had the time to write a book or felt it was something I wanted to do. Then Covid came and we had a lot of time. I went through the journals I had kept over the years and the notes I had made on team culture and leadership, and felt there was something of value I could get across in a book. I thought it would take about a year but it became two-and-a-half years.

Q. Your ODI debut in 2011 was in a match against India. Do you remember that day?

It was one of the most special days of my life as it marked my international debut for South Africa. I even tattooed it on my arm. It's something you work hard for in terms of getting that opportunity to play for your country. That entire year was special because it was also the year of my IPL debut.

Q. You talk about the 'Zipgate' controversy quite frankly in the book. How did you handle that phase of your life?

Zipgate was a challenging period for me, but as you'll see in the book, I speak about a lot of different instances that are not always easy to talk about. It was important for me to be honest about a lot of things that happened through my career as well as be vulnerable about it so that people could really see my heart and all of it. Zipgate was something bad that happened to me but a lot of good came from it. From a value perspective I made a real shift in direction after that.

Q. What has the experience of captaining RCB been like?

It has been incredible. It came at a time when people were thinking I was getting towards the end of my career because of my lack of playing international cricket and choosing to play more in the circuit in terms of T20 cricket. It gave me real purpose and I put all my energy towards building the team. Virat [Kohli] has been an exceptional support, and I'm grateful to him for letting me do things my way.

with Amit Dixit

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